

HARDIK CHHABRA

UPASANA TAKU, 46
Co-founder, Executive Director & CFO, MobiKwik
Gurugram

THE SHE LIST UNDER 50

THE **ENTREPRENEURS**

Queen of Payments

WOMAN TO WOMAN

"Believe in your ideas and pursue them with confidence; view obstacles as opportunities to learn and grow; surround yourself with mentors and peers who support and challenge you; persevere through setbacks and remain focused on your goals; and share your experiences to inspire and guide the next generation"

Working as a senior product manager at PayPal in San Jose, Upasana Taku witnessed first-hand how online payments were evolving in the US. So, when India began seeing a boom in e-commerce, she was ready. The Stanford graduate, born into a middle-class Kashmiri Pandit family settled in Gujarat's Gandhidham, went to school in Surat and studied engineering at NIT Jalandhar before moving to the US for a master's. She eventually returned to India in 2008 to set up an online payments system that would be quick and easy. That became the wallet firm MobiKwik, which she founded in 2009 with Bipin Preet Singh, whom she had met while watching a play in Delhi.

WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO

Upasana is one of India's earliest women fintech entrepreneurs who helped build the country's digital payments ecosystem

From co-founders, Bipin and Upasana soon became life partners too. In the early days, Upasana took on multiple roles—from writing website content and product specifications to coding, drafting press releases and even making offer letters. Even today, the couple continue to switch responsibilities; what hasn't changed is Upasana's focus on how the company manages its own finances and the people it hires. As CFO, she has ensured strong financial fundamentals for the business. It culminated in MobiKwik's blockbuster IPO in December 2024, which was subscribed nearly 120 times. The company's operating revenue for Q1FY27 rose to Rs 281.5 crore from Rs 271.4 crore in the same period last year.

A multitasker who enjoys swimming, cycling and reading, Upasana is leading the financial services firm to profitability. "Despite losses in the first three quarters due to headwinds in the consumer lending sector, we have been able to turn around the situation completely. In the past three quarters, we have had a hat-trick of profitable quarters at the PAT level," she says.

The company also received four new licences over the past year, two for its existing online merchant acquiring and offline payment aggregator businesses and two for its next phase of expansion—stockbroking and an NBFC, expected to start contributing from FY27 and broadening MobiKwik from a payments platform into a financial services provider. "It's a big vote of confidence from the regulator for our company," she says. Her next milestone? Making MobiKwik one of the top 10 UPI apps in the country from No. 12 currently. ■

— Sonal Khetarpal